



Start Your First Digital Product

From idea to first sale.

Turn your knowledge or ideas into a useful digital product people can actually buy.

Your path in 8 phases.

Follow them in order. Typical time shown, but go at your own pace.

01	Find Your Idea	Choose one idea worth turning into a product.	1 day
02	Know Your Customer	Describe exactly who your product is for.	2 days
03	Validate Before You Build	Check that people want it before you spend weeks on it.	3 to 5 days
04	Design Your Product	Plan a small product that delivers one clear result.	2 days
05	Create It	Build a first version you can sell within 2 weeks.	7 to 14 days
06	Price and Package	Set a fair price and a simple offer.	1 day
07	Set Up Your Store	Create a clear page where people can buy.	1 to 2 days
08	Launch and Sell	Tell the right people and make your first sales.	7 days

WHAT IS A DIGITAL PRODUCT?

Something you make once and sell many times, delivered online. For example:

Ebooks

Templates

Printables

Online courses

Checklists

Spreadsheets

Presets

Workshops

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- ☐ One idea (you will pick it in Phase 1)
- ☐ A free writing or design tool
- ☐ 30 minutes a day
- ☐ A way to get paid (set up in Phase 7)

01 Find Your Idea

Goal: Choose one idea worth turning into a product.

1 List what you know. Skills, subjects, experiences and problems you have solved.

2 Notice what people ask you. Questions friends or colleagues often bring to you.

3 Pick 3 possible ideas. Each should help one type of person solve one problem.

4 Score them. Use the scorecard below and choose the highest.

EXAMPLE People ask for my study notes, so my idea is revision templates for first-year students.

YOUR TURN

Score each idea from 1 to 5. Highest total wins.

Idea	I know it well	People need it	People pay for similar	I enjoy it	Total
1.					
2.					
3.					

My chosen idea: _____

CHECKPOINT Move on when: You have one top-scoring idea that excites you.

02 Know Your Customer

Goal: Describe exactly who your product is for.

1 Pick one person to help. Narrow beats broad. New freelancers, not “everyone”.

2 Find their main problem. What is frustrating, slow or confusing for them?

3 Talk to 5 people. Ask what they have tried and what they wish existed.

4 Use their words. Note the phrases they use. Reuse them on your product page.

EXAMPLE *New freelancers struggle to write proposals that win clients.*

YOUR TURN

Write two sentences about your customer.

WHO THEY ARE

THEIR BIGGEST PROBLEM

WHAT THEY HAVE TRIED

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

WHERE THEY SPEND TIME ONLINE

CHECKPOINT

Move on when: You can describe your customer and their problem in two sentences.

03 Validate Before You Build

Goal: Check that people want it before you spend weeks on it.

1 Share the idea. Post it or message it to people in your target group.

2 Ask for a small commitment. A reply, sign-up or pre-order beats “sounds nice”.

3 Offer a free sample. A short preview shows real interest.

4 Decide. Go ahead, adjust or pick another idea based on results.

EXAMPLE A sign-up page for a template pack gets 20 sign-ups in a week: go ahead.

YOUR TURN Run at least two tests before you build.

Test	Suggested target	My result
Talk to 5 people in my target group	5 conversations	
Post or poll in a community	10 replies	
Waitlist or sign-up page	20 sign-ups	
Pre-order or pilot offer	3 buyers	

MY DECISION

☐

Go ahead

☐

Adjust

☐

Try a new idea

CHECKPOINT

Move on when: You have real signals of interest, not just compliments.

04 Design Your Product

Goal: Plan a small product that delivers one clear result.

1 Choose a format. Template, ebook, checklist, mini-course or tool. Pick what is fastest to make.

2 Write your promise. Who it helps, what result they get and how fast.

3 Outline 5 parts. Each part is one step toward the result.

4 Cut the extras. Keep version one small. Add more later.

EXAMPLE Proposal Pack: 3 templates, 1 checklist and 1 email script.

YOUR TURN Plan it on one page.

PRODUCT NAME

FORMAT

- | | |
|--|------------------------------------|
| ☐ Ebook | ☐ Template |
| ☐ Mini-course | ☐ Checklist |
| ☐ Tool or sheet | ☐ Other |

MY PROMISE: I HELP ___ TO ___ IN ___

5-PART OUTLINE

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

CHECKPOINT Move on when: Your promise and outline fit on one page.

05 Create It

Goal: Build a first version you can sell within 2 weeks.

- 1 Make the core first.** Start with the most useful part, not the cover design.
- 2 Work in short sessions.** 45 minutes a day beats waiting for a free weekend.
- 3 Format for ease.** Clear headings, simple layout, files that open anywhere.
- 4 Test with 2 or 3 people.** Ask where they got stuck, then fix it.

EXAMPLE Write in Google Docs, design the cover in Canva, export as PDF.

YOUR TURN Build your first version in 14 days.

Days	Task	Done
Days 1 to 2	Outline and gather content	☐
Days 3 to 7	Create the core content	☐
Days 8 to 10	Format and design	☐
Days 11 to 12	Test with 2 or 3 people	☐
Days 13 to 14	Fix and finalise	☐

QUALITY CHECK

- ☐ Solves one clear problem
- ☐ Easy to follow
- ☐ No typos or broken links
- ☐ Consistent design
- ☐ Includes next steps

CHECKPOINT Move on when: Testers can use it without asking you questions.

06 Price and Package

Goal: Set a fair price and a simple offer.

1 Estimate your costs. Tools, design, platform fees and payment fees.

2 Price for the result. Think about what the problem costs your customer, not page count.

3 Keep it simple. One main product, maybe one bonus.

4 Test and adjust. You can change the price after your first few sales.

EXAMPLE Costs 300, price 25, 3 per sale: break-even at about 14 sales.

YOUR TURN

Work out your price and break-even point.

MY NUMBERS

Fixed costs (tools, design):

Cost per sale (fees):

My price:

Break-even sales = fixed costs ÷ (price - cost per sale)

Example: $300 \div (25 - 3) = 13.6$, so about 14 sales.

My break-even sales:

PRICE OPTIONS

Starter

Price:

Includes:

Standard

Price:

Includes:

Premium (optional)

Price:

Includes:

CHECKPOINT

Move on when: You know your price and how many sales cover your costs.

07 Set Up Your Store

Goal: Create a clear page where people can buy.

1 Pick a platform. Use a marketplace or store builder that handles payment and file delivery.

2 Write your product page. Lead with the result, then benefits, then who it is for.

3 Add proof. Previews, screenshots and tester feedback.

4 Cover the basics. Refund policy, contact email and local tax or licensing rules.

EXAMPLE Headline: "Write winning proposals in half the time."

YOUR TURN Check each item before you publish.

PRODUCT PAGE CHECKLIST

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Clear title and promise | ☐ 3 to 5 benefit points |
| ☐ Preview or sample | ☐ Simple, clear price |
| ☐ Who it is for | ☐ Short FAQ |
| ☐ Refund policy | ☐ Contact email |

WHERE I WILL SELL

- ☐ Online marketplace
 ☐ Store builder
 ☐ Own website

My page headline:

Check local rules for tax, refunds and licensing. This guide is not legal or financial advice.

CHECKPOINT

Move on when: A stranger can understand and buy in under 2 minutes.

08 Launch and Sell

Goal: Tell the right people and make your first sales.

1 Build anticipation. Share behind-the-scenes posts and open your waitlist.

2 Announce clearly. Say who it is for, what it does and where to buy.

3 Reach people directly. Message your waitlist and relevant communities. Follow their rules.

4 Follow up. Thank buyers and ask for feedback and reviews.

EXAMPLE “I just launched Proposal Pack. It helps new freelancers win clients. Get it here.”

YOUR TURN

Fill in your dates and tick as you go.

7 DAYS BEFORE

☐ Open a waitlist

☐ Post 3 teasers

☐ Finish product page

☐ Test the checkout

LAUNCH DAY

☐ Post announcement

☐ Email your waitlist

☐ Message 10 people

☐ Reply to comments

7 DAYS AFTER

☐ Thank every buyer

☐ Ask for feedback

☐ Share early reviews

☐ Note what worked

MY ANNOUNCEMENT: I JUST LAUNCHED ____ . IT HELPS ____ TO ____ . GET IT HERE: ____

CHECKPOINT

Move on when: Your product is live, announced and your first buyers are thanked.

Learn, improve, **grow.**

Your first version is the start. Track a few numbers and keep improving.

1 Collect feedback

Ask every buyer 3 questions: What helped?
What was confusing?
What is missing?

2 Improve one thing

Change one element at a time: the title, price or preview. Then compare results.

3 Grow

Add a bonus, bundle, update or a second product for the same customer.

YOUR TURN

Track four numbers each week.

Week	Visitors	Sales	Revenue	What I learned
Week 1				
Week 2				
Week 3				
Week 4				

Conversion rate = sales ÷ visitors. Example: 2 sales from 100 visitors = 2%.

REMEMBER

Your first sale proves the idea works. Keep listening to your customers.

Launch in 30 days.

One focus per week. Tick each task as you finish it.

Week 1

☐ Choose your idea

☐ Interview 5 customers

☐ Start your waitlist

Week 2

☐ Run validation tests

☐ Decide: go, adjust or change

☐ Write your promise and outline

Week 3

☐ Create the core content

☐ Format and design it

☐ Test with 2 or 3 people

Week 4

☐ Set your price

☐ Build your product page

☐ Launch and thank buyers

START TODAY

Your first sale starts with your first step.

This guide offers general business ideas. It is not legal, tax or financial advice. Results vary.